

clicking the rightmost icon on it. The size of the panel can be changed and widgets can be added to it.

The interesting thing about PC-BSD is the icon on the right top of the desktop which allows users to add widgets to the desktop. This is similar to the widgets found in Windows Vista and Windows 7. Widgets are tiny applications that can be fixed to the desktop. Adding them is simple. Click the icon on the right top and click on Add Widgets. Double click on a widget to install it. The widgets can be moved around the desktop. The options for the widgets can be accessed clicking on the widget itself.

All the system preferences can be accessed by clicking on the Start button and then on System Settings. The default web browser is Konqueror which is something that comes with KDE based distributions. The latest version of Firefox also comes installed and so does Thunderbird, the mail client.

The Computer menu is the equivalent of the Places menu in Gnome distributions. When you right-click on the desktop, the alternate menu is also lets you run applications using the Run command option. Customising the desktop can also be done from here.

5.7.2 Installing applications

Installing applications on PC-BSD is done using the Add/Remove Software utility. It's available under the Applications > System section in the start menu. Preinstalled applications and components can be removed from this program as well.

One of the good things about PC-BSD is the package manager. Where as other open source operating systems require compiling of source packages, PC-BSD works in a similar manner as Windows. Precompiled packages are available and are really simple to install. The format used is .PBI. Doubling clicking on a file starts a wizard-style installation procedure. Uninstalling programs can be done in a similar manner.

5.7.3 Special applications

There are some fundamental applications and services put into PC-BSD which make it different from other distributions. There are packet filters and firewalls that are a part of OpenBSD. There is a process that fine adjusts CPU depending on the